

DECENTRALIZED MASTERS

MARKET UPDATE

Weekly Research Briefing

July 27, 2026

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Decentralized Masters

IRAN PAUSE

OIL -6%

FOMC WED

MSFT/META/AAPL/AMZN

WTI Crude

~\$83

per barrel

-6% today

Brent Crude

~\$90

per barrel

-7% today

Gold (Spot)

\$4,116

per ounce

+0.6% today

FOMC Jul 29

~80%

Hold probability

20% hike risk

Iran: US Paused Strikes Late Friday:

No official announcement. Iran confirmed pause. Brent had hit \$102 last week — now down to ~\$89-92. Oil fell 5-7% at open. Markets risk-on.

Intel Q2 — Beat Massive, Stock Still -7.89%:

Revenue \$16.1B (+25%), EPS \$0.42 (nearly doubled). But capex raised from \$18B to >\$20B. Same pattern as TSMC, Alphabet — sell the capex raise.

FOMC: Hold Probability Recovering:

Fell to 64% as Brent hit \$102. Now recovering toward ~75-80% with oil retreat. Warsh press conference Wednesday 2pm is the week's key communication.

Week: FOMC + MSFT + META + GDP + PCE + AAPL + AMZN:

The most information-dense single week of Q2 2026. Every major AI hyperscaler reports, plus the rate decision and key economic data.

IRAN: US PAUSES STRIKES — OIL FALLS 5-7%

Start of July

~\$70

Post-June ceasefire MoU

Last Week Peak

\$102

Brent; 13 nights of strikes

Friday Close

~\$98

Still up 12%+ for week

Today (Mon)

~\$90

Iran pause; down 7%

What happened:

US paused strikes vs. Iran starting late Friday with no official announcement. Iran told Reuters it would halt retaliatory strikes as long as US pause holds. Trump open to Oman-mediated talks.

What caused the pause:

Reports indicate US military was running low on viable targets and interceptor supplies after 13 consecutive nights of strikes. Not a diplomatic breakthrough — a practical pause.

What's still active:

Houthi claimed Red Sea attacks on Saudi Aramco facilities in Jizan and Yanbu over the weekend. No formal ceasefire. Hormuz still below pre-war traffic levels. The structural supply disruption persists.

What it means for FOMC:

Oil at \$83 WTI vs \$102 Brent peak changes the rate hike calculus significantly. Hold probability recovering from 64% toward 75-80%. Warsh still has July CPI risk ahead (out mid-August).

The key risk:

Iran-backed forces or fresh diplomatic collapse could re-escalate rapidly. No signed framework exists. This is a fragile pause, not a resolution.

INTEL Q2: BEAT OF THE YEAR — STILL SOLD ON CAPEX

Revenue

\$16.1B

vs \$14.4B est.

+12% beat

Non-GAAP EPS

\$0.42

vs \$0.21-0.22 est.

Near doubled

DC & AI Segment

+59%

YoY growth

AI server demand

2026 Capex

>\$20B

was \$18B guidance

Raised again

THE AI CAPEX FEAR PATTERN — CONSISTENT ACROSS ALL NAMES

TSMC

-3.64%

Capex \$60-64B

Alphabet

-1.2%

Capex \$195-205B

Tesla

-4.7%

Opex +47%

Intel

-7.89%

Capex >\$20B

THE CLEAN POSITIVE:

Q3 guidance \$16.3B midpoint (above \$14.4B consensus). CEO: 'AI driving unprecedented compute demand.' Seventh consecutive quarter of exceeding own guidance. Foundry 18A progress on track — Apple + Microsoft design partnerships confirmed. Intel is winning. The market is just afraid of the bill.

FOMC JULY 29: HOLD EXPECTED — STATEMENT IS THE INFO

HOLD PROBABILITY TRAJECTORY

Jul 13 (post-CPI)	83%
Jul 17	87%
Jul 24 (Brent \$102)	64%
Jul 27 (Iran pause)	~80%

ALSO ON THURSDAY (Jul 30)

US Q2 GDP (Advance)

First read on Q2 growth rate — labor softening vs. AI capex boom

June PCE Price Index

Fed's preferred gauge; June = partial Hormuz reopening energy drop

Bank of England Decision

3.75% expected hold; hawkish 7-2 Jun vote; energy inflation watch

Apple + Amazon (AH)

Consumer AI cycle + AWS enterprise AI workload read-through

Hold + Neutral Statement

~60%

BTC: \$66,800 → \$70K target

Warsh: brief, no Sept signal. Risk-on across assets.

Hold + Hawkish Language

~25%

BTC: Range \$63-66K

'Upside inflation risk' phrase = Sept hike signal.

Surprise 25bp Hike

~15%

BTC: \$61-63K re-test

Oil at \$83 makes this very unlikely. Tail risk only.

THE BUSIEST WEEK OF THE QUARTER: FOMC + 4 HYPERSCALERS

MON
Jul 27

Iran pause
markets risk-on
Oil -6%

TUE
Jul 28

FOMC Day 1
no announcements

Durable Goods

WED
Jul 29

★★★★ FOMC 2pm

★★ Microsoft
(AH)

★★ Meta (AH)

THU
Jul 30

★★ Apple (AH)

★★ Amazon (AH)

Q2 GDP + PCE

FRI
Jul 31

ExxonMobil
Chevron Earnings

End of
Q2 earnings

CRYPTO OVERVIEW — CATCHING THE IRAN PAUSE BID

July 27, 2026

Bitcoin

\$65,333

+1.6% today

+1.6% today

Ethereum

~\$1,953

+4.3% today

+4.3% today

Solana

~\$76.12

+1.5% today

+1.5% today

ETF Inflows

Wk 3+

Streak continues

Streak continues

THE WEEK'S CRYPTO CONTEXT

- Iran pause + oil falling → lower rate hike odds → risk-on → crypto catches the bid. BTC +1.6%, ETH +4.3% this morning.
- ETH outperforming BTC (ETH/BTC 0.030) is a risk-on signal within crypto — capital rotating from BTC toward alts/ETH.
- BTC ETF inflow streak now tracking week 3+ — modest daily flows but the sustained streak is the institutional signal.
- FOMC Wednesday is the binary: neutral hold = BTC targets \$66,800+ and \$70K. Hawkish language = ceiling at \$65-66K. Surprise hike = \$61-63K.

BITCOIN: \$65,333 — THE FOMC IS THE NEXT CATALYST

BT
C

KEY PRICE LEVELS

Target (FOMC hold): \$66,800 → \$70K

Neutral statement unlocks this range

50-month EMA: ~\$65,600

Now acting as support after multiple holds

200-day MA: ~\$65,200

Clustered with 50-mo EMA — zone is support

Current Price: \$65,333

Holding in the EMA zone; +1.6% today

Support 1: \$63,000-64,000

Week's low range; first defense level

Support 2: \$61,000-61,750

Key structural zone on FOMC downside

ETF FLOWS — WEEK 3 STATUS

Jul 7-11 (Wk 1) **\$282M net**

8-wk streak ended
Jul 14-18 (Wk 2) **\$75M net**

Volatile but positive
Jul 21-25 (Wk 3) **Positive**

Streak continues
Jul AUM **~>\$79B**

Was \$71B in late June

FOMC WEDNESDAY — BTC SCENARIOS

Neutral hold **\$66,800 → \$70K** **60%**

Hawkish hold **\$63-66K range** **25%**

Surprise hike **\$61-63K** **15%**

ETH + CLARITY:

ETH \$1,953 (+4.3% today) outperforming BTC — risk-on signal. ETH/BTC 0.030, recovering. CLARITY Act: 11 days to Aug 7 recess. No cloture motion filed yet. Cloture filing = Thune has 60 votes = passes. Watch Senate floor schedule this week.

CLARITY ACT + AI EARNINGS — THE WEEK'S TWIN CATALYSTS

CLARITY ACT — 11 DAYS

AUGUST 7 RECESS = HARD DEADLINE — 11 DAYS

- Bill at Senate Calendar No. 423 — eligible for floor, no cloture filed
- Majority Leader Thune has not allocated floor time
- Polymarket passage odds: 43-48% (down from 55% earlier in month)
- Need 60 votes for cloture; 53 R seats; Hawley + Paul = No votes
- Democratic ask: ethics/conflict rules targeting officials' crypto assets
- Key trigger: Cloture motion filing by Jul 30 = Thune has 60 votes counted
- If no cloture by Jul 30 → September at EARLIEST → midterm climate
- This week's FOMC/earnings distraction works against legislative focus

MSFT/META/AAPL/AMZN — THE AI VERDICT

Microsoft (MSFT) — Wed AH

DECISIVE for AI narrative

Azure growth rate (guided 39-40% CC). Copilot 20M+ paid seats. FY27 capex ~\$262B analyst model. MSFT -21% YTD on capex fears.

Meta (META) — Wed AH

AI monetization check

AI ad targeting revenue. Llama ecosystem adoption. 2026 capex guidance. Llam 3.1 scaling results. User engagement metrics.

Apple (AAPL) — Thu AH

Consumer AI demand

AI feature adoption driving upgrade cycles? iPhone 17 pre-orders? Services revenue. Consumer AI assistant penetration.

Amazon (AMZN) — Thu AH

Enterprise AI ROI

AWS AI workload growth. Operating leverage from cloud. Kuiper satellite. Advertising AI. Operating margin expansion.

If MSFT Azure 42%+ + Copilot revenue = AI narrative FLIPS. Tech rally, crypto tailwind.
If miss or high capex = AI fear extends. SOX down again.

01

FOMC — Wednesday 2pm

Hold Very Likely. Statement Decides BTC Direction.

- ~80% hold probability with oil now at \$83. Oil falling today means hike odds continue to ease.
- Watch for 'upside risk to inflation outlook' in the statement — that phrase = September hike live = ceiling on rally.
- Clean neutral hold: BTC breaks \$66,800, targets \$70K. ETF inflows extend. Risk-on environment.

02

MSFT + META Wednesday AH

The AI Revenue Verdict

- Azure growth rate vs capex is the defining data point of Q2 earnings season. MSFT -21% YTD on capex fears.
- Beat on Azure (42%+ CC) + Copilot revenue evidence = AI narrative flips. SOX recovery, crypto tailwind.
- Miss or capex raise only = fear narrative extends. TSMC/Alphabet/Intel pattern repeats a 4th time.

03

CLARITY Act + AAPL/AMZN

11 Days / Consumer + Cloud AI

- Watch Senate floor announcements for cloture motion filing — the only signal that matters before Aug 7.
- Apple: consumer AI adoption story; Amazon: AWS operating leverage — both feed into the broader risk narrative.
- FOMC hold + MSFT beat + CLARITY progress = BTC targets \$70K+ this week. All three needed.